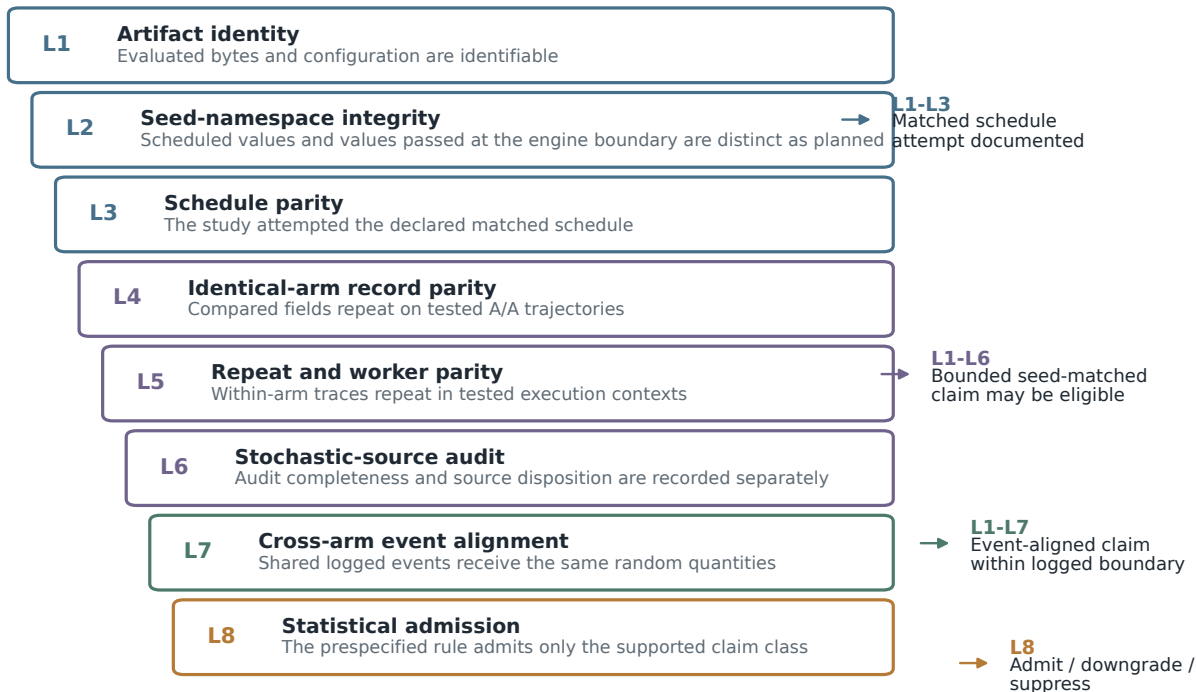


Paired Evaluation Validity Ladder



Levels 1-7 are cumulative evidence gates. Level 8 is a prespecified claim-admission decision, not evidence that repairs a failed gate.